

Stories of the week

NATIONAL: Five people were killed in an Amazon-branded cargo plane accident at Miami International Airport. Five other people were injured.

INTERNATIONAL: The United Kingdom, France, Canada and nine other countries announced they are banning trade with Israeli settlements in the occupied West Bank.

MICE MISTREATMENT

The project’s principal investigator, Paul Dent, self-reported to the Committee on June 15 and voluntarily suspended all animal testing in the days following. Dent is no longer listed as a principal investigator on any other projects.

Michael Budkie, executive director of Stop Animal Exploitation NOW stated in an email that animal testing treats animals as if they are discardable and inanimate and calls on VCU to ban Dent from future animal research.

“Failure to follow the protocol both abuses animals and makes seriously flawed ‘science’ even worse,” Budkie stated.

The IACUC voted to suspend the project until Dent met with Animal Care and Use Program leadership and the action plan was determined, according to an official NIH document. Due to protocol violation, the research was not allowed to be published.

The Massey Comprehensive Cancer Center preclinical trial aimed to understand how a specific protein variant impacted cancer treatment.

In an official complaint to VCU, Stop Animal Exploitation Now stated, “Failure to follow these endpoints means that animals endured extreme suffering because lab workers were either unconcerned and couldn’t be bothered to perform euthanasia, or they intentionally chose not to perform the euthanasia/pain relief to collect more data.”

VCU animal research guidelines abide by the three Rs: Reduction, Replacement and Refinement which aim to minimize

the use of animals and provide humane treatment, according to the VCU Animal Care and Use Program. All protocols involving animals must be approved by the Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee prior to testing.

“This matter did not involve research misconduct,” VCU Public Relations stated in an email. “Rather, this matter was identified during routine monitoring by the Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee.”

The project received \$257,125 in funding by an award from the National Institute of Health, spanning from 2024 to June 30 due to suspension, according to VCU Public Relations specialists.

The awarded funds have been retracted and reabsorbed, and Budkie has called on VCU to return the funding to the National Institutes of Health, according to the Richmond Times Dispatch.

“This is the most common violation that we see,” Budkie stated. “While not all of these failures are this serious in terms of animal welfare, this is still a major issue. This usually does not become public.”

VCU laboratories have a history of self-reports involving animal mistreatment, including three instances in April due to negligence, improper pain management and administration of unapproved drugs. The university has experienced backlash for National Institute of Health-funded animal testing projects, including using hard drugs on animal subjects, according to ABC News.

The VCU animal research lab received



VCU President Michael Rao gives his ‘State of the University’ address at James Branch Cabell Library on Feb. 12. CT file photo by Andrew Kerley.

notable increases in funding year-over-year, experiencing a 54% increase between 2020 and 2024. VCU also plans to purchase the Altria Center for Research and Technology for \$230 million.

VCU president Michael Rao announced that he planned on transforming VCU research from a national to an international hub during the 2026 annual State of the Research event, according to VCU News.

Budkie stated that animal research continues to attract federal funding.

Sen. William Stanley failed to pass a bill last session, that would have required detailed accounts of animal health, funding

and operations within animal research labs to ensure transparency and accountability.

The VCU Animal Care and Use Program said that while it is possible to achieve a future without animal testing, no alternatives currently suffice.

“Moving to better technology (organ on a chip tech, 3D bioprinting, etc.) would eliminate the use of animals,” Budkie stated. “This will generate better, more accurate science because it removes inter-species differences.”

Virginians vote on reproductive freedom in November

DEBORAH AGUILERA
Contributing Writer

Virginians will decide whether reproductive freedom should be a fundamental right in the state constitution on Nov. 3.

Question 1 on the ballot proposes that every individual has the fundamental right to reproductive freedom, including personal decisions regarding prenatal care, childbirth, postpartum care, contraception, abortion care, miscarriage management and fertility care.

Currently, reproductive healthcare is a statutory protection in Virginia, meaning it can be altered by future legislative majorities, according to KFF. Making reproductive healthcare a constitutional amendment would guarantee Virginians the right to reproductive freedom.

Following the U.S. Supreme Court’s 2022 decision to overturn Roe v. Wade, the authority to regulate abortion was returned to the states. Virginia currently stands as the last state in the South with abortion access passed the 15th week.

According to Reproductive Freedom for All, under Virginia law, constitutional

amendments must pass two consecutive General Assembly sessions with a legislative election in between. The measure cleared the 2025 and 2026 legislative sessions and will now go directly to the voters.

Jamie Lockhart, the executive director of Planned Parenthood Advocates for Virginia, discussed the organization’s mission, which includes educating the public about reproductive health issues and engaging with Virginia communities.

In addition to its educational and advocacy efforts, the organization evaluates candidates for public office based on their stances on reproductive health and endorses candidates whose views align, Lockhart said.

The amendment would protect an individual’s ability to make decisions about their reproductive health while limiting government involvement in those decisions, Lockhart said.

“This amendment protects the freedom to reproductive decisions and ensures the government cannot intervene,” Lockhart said.

Planned Parenthood Generation Action at VCU is a student organization that brings the mission and resources of Planned Parenthood to the university community.

The group focuses on providing students with information about reproductive and sexual health while creating a space where students can learn about available resources and healthcare options.

The organization aims to make conversations about sexual health more approachable for students, according to Anna Ndahi, an executive board member at PPGA.

The group’s purpose is to reduce the shame surrounding sexual health and to keep students educated on the matter, Ndahi said. Through education and campus activities, the group provides students with opportunities to learn about topics related to sexual and reproductive health.

learn about topics related to sexual and reproductive health.

Reproductive healthcare and individual decision-making are central to the organization’s advocacy, Ndahi said. “reproductive healthcare ensures voluntary autonomy,” She stated that “reproductive healthcare can save lives.”

Generation Action seeks to connect students with information and resources while encouraging conversations on campus.



Courtesy of VCU Planned Parenthood Generation Action.



Courtesy of VCU Planned Parenthood Generation Action.



Courtesy of VCU Planned Parenthood Generation Action.

When GAS submitted their application, it was not sent to the VCU Office of Student Life, but instead the Board of Visitors, which was an unusual practice. The VCU BOV ultimately rejected their application, claiming that it was not in the best interest of the institution. The GAS was the only one denied in the 1975 school year out of 145 organization applications.

According to Justia, this led one student to sue Alfred T. Matthews, Dean of Student Life and Wyndham B. Blanton Jr., member of the Board of Visitors, for recognition as an official organization, and to grant GAS with the same resources as other student organizations on campus.

The landmark occasion became for an outlet for LGBTQ+ students and staff to commemorate and advocate for their community among campus, according to Josh Leidy, director of affinity programs at VCU.

Leidy said he hopes that the historical marker will be representative of a moment of hope, especially in a time where things can feel dark and upsetting.

“VCU has a responsibility to make sure that they are giving support and resources to all of their students, regardless of their gender identity or sexual identity,” Leidy said.

Leidy said he partnered with VCU to host several events, including Lavender Mic, an open mic for students and alumni to share their stories and experiences. They worked with the library to provide an archive and research guide on the GAS.

“This [marker] is the culmination of

year-long events and other initiatives we have done,” Leidy said. “This is sort of the end of a really intentional year that my office and VCU has put together to push forward progress for the LGBTQ community.”

William Sachau, VCU GAS secretary and vice president from 1984 to 1985, shared the society’s main goals, which mainly centered around educating the VCU community on LGBTQ issues.

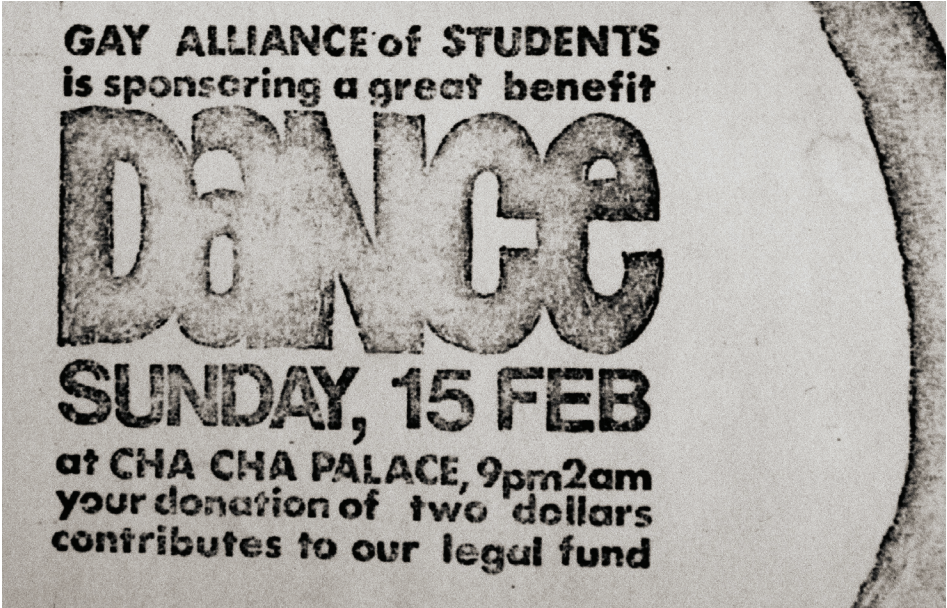
“There was a lot of education needed at that time, especially in Richmond. It was a very hostile place for LGBTQ people, and VCU was sort of like a bubble within Richmond,” Sachau said.

The GAS landmark for the GAS is an important feature added to VCU’s campus, because it highlights the community’s journey, according to Sachau.

“Everything is so cyclical in history,” Sachau said. “You have times where you have more victories, and lately we’ve had more defeats. But having something like this to note our place in society, and that we will keep trying to move forward to educate the community at large about LGBTQ equality,”

Sachau reflected on the difficulties of advocating for LGBTQ equality in the 80s, amidst the HIV and AIDS epidemic. He said it is a part of history that students should be more aware of.

“We have aspirations like everybody else,” Sachau said. “We want to build families. We want to build friendships and connections. We want to contribute to society. So just having a place at the table, and keeping that place at the table.”



October 28th, 2026 marks the 50th anniversary of Gay Alliance of Students v. Matthews, which forced the VCU Board of Visitors to accept the Gay Alliance of Students’ application as an official club after a 2 year legal battle. Photo by William Spencer.



Former Governors Jim Gilmore and L. Douglas Wilder on stage during the Virginia at 250 Symposium on September 1st, 2026. Photo by John Brown

Democracy and Spanberger: Wilder School holds ‘Virginia at 250’ symposium

KAYLA MUÑECAS
Assistant News Editor

VCU’s Wilder School of Government and Public Affairs held a “Virginia at 250” symposium to commemorate the nation’s 250th anniversary on Sep. 1.

The panelists included Robyn Diehl McDouggle, interim dean of the Wilder School, former Gov. L. Douglas Wilder, former Gov. Jim Gilmore and political analyst and founder of the University of Virginia Center for Politics, Larry Sabato.

Political analyst Bob Holsworth mediated the panel.

“The Wilder School’s symposium is one of our key programs that we do annually and it really follows what [former] Gov. Wilder is always saying, which is that the people are ahead of the politicians and politics,” McDouggle said.

The panel’s discussion surrounded concerns about democracy and heightened political polarization and how Virginians feel about the state’s direction and the importance of civil discourse.

McDouggle, who established the Commonwealth Poll, said that Virginia differs in comparison to other states because it is more issue driven rather than party driven.

“Our founding fathers would have been very ecstatic for that kind of bipartisan belief for around one issue,” McDouggle said. “That’s an example and a very partisan decision that policies really are impacting voter interests.”

McDouggle said Spanberger came into office at the height of redistricting efforts and likely struggled to frame the issues on her agenda due to redistricting.

According to McDouggle, a Commonwealth Poll showed that Gov. Abigail Spanberger’s approval rating fell in the low 40s, despite winning the election by double-digits.

“One of the things I think did drive a bit of that was the uncertainty with the budge” McDouggle said. “The budget is a relationship between the legislature and the governor, and it’s the longest we’ve gone without a budget.”

Former Virginia Gov. Jim Gilmore said that parties have evolved beyond what they once were.

“This is no longer the Democratic and Republican parties of John F. Kennedy and Richard Nixon, that’s not what’s going on,” Gilmore said.

Gilmore said he believes the media is partially to blame for intense partiality.

“The problem is that the public is not being discerning about what they’re seeing and whether or not they’re making a decision based upon propaganda or reality,” Gimore said. “And this is heightened by this media society that we live in.”

Political analyst Larry Sabato said that knowledge is key in facilitating discussion.

“When we don’t know what’s going on and we don’t understand the issues...we can’t make a well-informed choice,” Sabato said. We have to understand that both sides have something to be said.”

According to a Commonwealth Poll in February, over 40% of Virginians reported that they headed to the polls over concerns of maintaining democracy.

According to a Commonwealth Poll

in July, 81% of registered voters support requiring data centers to offset their impact on the state’s electric infrastructure. Seventy two percent of registered voters opposed granting data centers tax cuts as incentive.

Sabato said that if politicians do not explain their plans of action involving data centers to the public, they should not be surprised by the public’s reaction.

“That’s one reason why [the Iran] war is becoming extremely massively unpopular,” Sabato said. “Data centers are another good example.”

Sabato said that in stagnant political times, voters tend to vote for the opposition and demand quick change, forgetting however unhappy they might have been with their predecessor.

Wilder prompted Spanberger to heed the polls and begin to work on the issues she campaigned on.

“If you resonate with the people, if you listen to the people, if you do something and the record shows that you have done something for the people, they’ll hear you,” Wilder said. “And once they hear you, they will respond.”

Quote of the week

“The more I am aware of my mortality the better person I am and the better I am at choosing a life that is aware of its beauty.”
— Ada Limón

The climate crisis is here

URJITA MAINALI
Contributing Writer

On Aug. 26, a flash flood with the magnitude of a 5.2 earthquake hit the region around the Nepal-Tibet-China border, according to CNN Weather.

Natural disasters have previously hit Nepal, with the region often preparing for extreme weather. Monsoon rains make travel difficult or dangerous, especially in more rural and mountainous regions as the roads fall into disrepair. It is also a seismically active region, according to BBC News, making it prone to earthquakes and landslides.

While it always made me worry for my family, news about natural disasters has never been entirely unexpected — but when I saw the first videos coming out of the massive waves of water, mud and debris, I felt that the scale of this disaster was different.

At the time of writing, the death toll has surpassed 1,290 in Nepal, and thousands remain missing.

In the days following the disaster, experts linked the deadly flash floods to a glacial collapse in the Himalayan region associated with climate change, according to The Guardian. In the region,

temperatures have been recorded as warming twice as fast.

The lives impacted and lost by flood-related disasters have risen rapidly across South and Southeast Asia, a trend that is likely to continue and worsen. Nepali Prime Minister Balen Shah has called upon the international community to support efforts to mitigate the impacts of climate change, citing it as a global responsibility.

Yet, the impacts of climate change are incredibly disproportionate between the Global North, responsible for the majority of carbon emissions, and the Global South, the most affected regions. Lately, I have noticed that this discrepancy exists in how the West speaks and educates about climate change as well.

Most conversation, in and outside of the classroom, posits the climate crisis as a looming threat on the horizon. The focus is on what will happen if climate change is not mitigated — flooding, worsening disasters and the impacts of AI data centers and personal AI usage, according to Cornell Chronicle and United Nations, respectively. The base of our knowledge, usually taught since elementary school, about the changing climate emphasizes

our personal actions in an effort to avoid a “point of no return” — notably, one that was set in the future.

With this knowledge, it is understandable that conversation around climate change still posits the point of crisis in the future, especially in the West, where it seems that climate change is remarked upon most when the weather is poor.

But we have reached that point of no return, according to the UN as reported by CBC news. The climate crisis is here.

In the Global South, rising temperatures and sea levels have made many regions inhospitable and millions of individuals are forced to consider leaving their homes for their safety and livelihoods. Some nations are at risk of being entirely submerged, leading to a loss of life and culture that cannot be undone. Natural disasters have worsened, rain and flood patterns have changed, infectious disease poses greater risks and unprecedented heat waves threaten lives.

These are not predicted futures — this is the reality of millions as you read this.

The climate crisis is not only affecting the Global South. In the United States, natural disasters have occurred more frequently, at

greater scales and regions impacted by natural disasters are expanding.

Coastal and island regions in Europe are at risk for flooding and are also experiencing rising temperatures and consequent health risks posed by heat.

The way we talk about climate change has to expand and evolve to reflect the climate crisis we are facing now. While you should not intentionally pursue a lifestyle that will contribute to a higher climate impact, putting responsibility onto the individual is not a feasible solution.

We need the conversation to go beyond what the impacts of climate change will be and begin to include how we will respond to the impacts that are here now. Massive, sustainable infrastructure change and development is necessary and needed most where it is the hardest to acquire.

As students, the careers that we pursue are likely to touch the climate in one way or another. With this change in focus and paradigm, perhaps it will be possible for us to respond to the reality of the world we live in now. In order to prevent dozens more estimates, predictions and projections from becoming reality, our focus needs to be on the present.

Society’s ‘Obsession’ with romantic dehumanization

BELLA FRATARCANGELO
Contributing Writer

Director Curry Barker’s low-budget horror hit, “Obsession,” tells audiences what most women have known for centuries: nice guys are often not nice guys, they are not nice lovers and cool girls do not exist.

In “Obsession,” a twenty-something “nice guy” named Bear wishes on a collectible children’s toy that his long-time crush, Nikki, would love him more than anyone else in the entire world. From this moment until the curse is broken, the real Nikki loses her autonomy and embodies a caricature of a crazy girlfriend, nicknamed Freaky Nikki.

Barker, in an interview with “The Collider,” rebuked the notion that “Obsession” is a story of someone “possessed” by a demonic entity or ancient spirit. I interpret Nikki as Bear’s possession, a reward he supposedly deserves after years of sweatily pinching the sleeves of his vintage sweater collection, pining after an artsy baddie. To him, her inauthentic, ham-fisted, manic love is preferable to romantic rejection.

Nikki is dehumanized by the male gaze — specifically, Bear’s gaze.

Told through Bear’s perspective, the film only confronts fleeting moments of Nikki’s suffering that are unavoidable for Bear. The audience does not get to know Nikki intimately. She is only the object of Bear’s affection and the victim of his selfishness.

Male audiences fear living with a Freaky Nikki. Female audiences fear living as the real Nikki.

“Traditional” relationships are characterized by a power imbalance between those who possess someone and are pleased by them and the possessed who pleases. “Obsession” is a snapshot of how centuries of traditional relationships have marred value appraisal or bestowal



Illustration by Devin Smith.

practices in romance.

Philosophers have historically confused appraisal and bestowal of value with one another. This confusion can be defined by the Euthyphros Problem: “Does love appraise what is valuable in the beloved, or does love bestow value onto the beloved as a person?”

I firmly believe that both are at the core of a healthy relationship.

To be loved is to be valued. To give love is to value. However, as philosopher Irving Singer wrote in “The Nature of Love,” love and the want for love are not “inherently moral.” Bestowal involves participation in, appreciation of and partnership through someone’s smiles, frowns, ups and downs. Although Bear feels a twisted responsibility for Freaky Nikki (as the progenitor of her neuroticism) he does not desire for the real Nikki to return for any other reason than to do away with Freaky Nikki.

Bear never wanted to love Nikki — he wanted her to love him.

“Obsession” is a pulp morality tale for

Gen Z. Bear appraises Nikki, bestows next to nothing on her value as a person and disregards her freedom to reject him. Barker ascribes horrific fictional consequences to a timeless patriarchal fantasy: the cool girl.

In “Gone Girl,” author Gillian Flynn describes this fantasy: “Cool girls never get angry, they only smile in a chagrined, loving manner and let their men do whatever they want.”

In reality, cool girls are pretenders who act as what men want with no complaints, for the purpose of earning empty affection. The demand and supply for cool girls is systemic.

In “The Nature of Love,” Singer declares that reciprocity of bestowal is the best method to develop authentic, enjoyable love with another human being. Still, in heterosexual relationships, women are socially expected to commit the lion’s share of bestowal while men are socially expected to serially appraise women, bestowing little upon them. Furthermore, everyone, regardless of gender, is expected

to self-appraise to self-extinction.

All of these social expectations are echoed throughout popular online communities and trends: the Red Pill movement, trad wives, love robots and chatbots, femcels and pick-me girls, couples content and so on.

Nothing good comes from othering and dehumanizing our potential lovers. It is my hypothesis, as a seasoned armchair psychologist, that the root of Gen Z’s loneliness epidemic is appraisal prioritization. Everyone, especially men, needs to remind themselves that romantic partners are multi-dimensional human beings. If you want a sex robot, buy a sex robot. If you want to love another human being, try finding a life partner. If you are not prepared to be a life partner, try finding self-fulfillment.

Lesbians, please stop fighting

MARITZA BAPTISTE
Staff Writer

Every time I open my Twitter feed, I am bombarded by in-fighting amongst the lesbian community.

Suddenly, it is considered weird to call your butch partner your boyfriend or to call yourself a lesbian if you are dating a trans man. According to some Twitter lesbians, butch/femme relationships are heteronormative.

Topics like these, labeled as discourse, have become widespread invalidation of identities that are interwoven in lesbian and queer history — and they are predominantly happening within lesbian spaces.

I have identified as a lesbian for over two years now. My sexuality was truly an awakening for me and I have spent the last two years loving the liberation it has given me. But just as I was coming to know myself, I also had to acquaint myself with a community I was mostly unfamiliar with.

A plethora of dating roles and identities fall under the umbrella of lesbianism. Butch lesbians, femme lesbians, lesbians using he/him pronouns and trans masc lesbians all exist within the community but these identities are largely misunderstood.

Many of these conventions challenged my previous perceptions of lesbianism being a restrictive label and I came to realize that it is far more expansive. I had to learn over time that queerness can seem contradictory even when it is not. I see the errors of my previous mindset reflected in the recent “discourse,” especially in those who have taken it upon themselves to decide who is and is not “lesbian enough.”

While ignorance is a glaring issue, intolerance is widening the gap between acceptance and invalidation. In our conflict, we are using the tools of our oppressors against ourselves.

Historically, queer communities have been subjected to scrutiny over how we identify and present ourselves. Producing that same scrutiny towards butch lesbians, trans masc lesbians or relationship dynamics when they do not fit into your idea of what a lesbian is, whether you are one or not, is reductive towards the historical work done by lesbians just to exist.

Not all discourse is anti-queer. There are valid conversations to be had around transphobia, misogyny, racism and biphobia within the lesbian community. However, this is not discourse or the

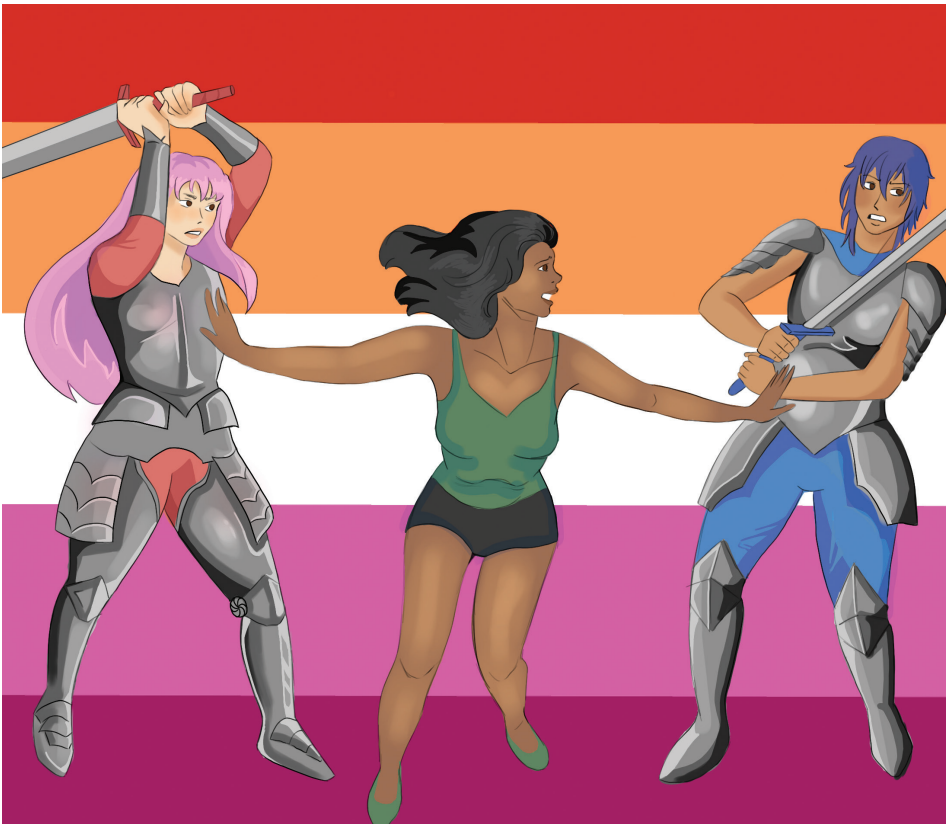


Illustration By Zahraa Hadi

calling out of problematic behavior. It is anti-queer, ignorant rhetoric from those who think their identity by itself grants them authority.

Queerness does not have to make sense. Queerness is meant to live outside of social norms and boundaries.

It is contradictory, it is boundless and it is beautiful. It does not take a complete and total understanding of an identity to

respect it.

Lesbians, please stop fighting with each other. Lesbianism looks different on everyone.

Let us celebrate the liberation we have sought through queerness with respect and love for one another. Let us do away with creating boundaries and instead embody the expansive queerness of lesbianism.



Illustration by Zoe Luis.

The commuter problem does not end at the parking deck

MOLLY CHRISTIANSON
Staff Writer

Virginia Commonwealth University simply does not have enough dorms to house the majority of its students, and because of that, many students commute. Many find off-campus housing within walking distance or at least a short drive away. However, there are still students who drive 30 minutes to an hour to get to campus.

There are numerous parking decks in and around campus that students can buy passes for and this is something VCU does well. It is easy — or at least as easy as it can be — to commute to a giant school in the middle of a city.

However, just because VCU has made it easier for commuters to get to campus does not mean commuters are comfortable once they are there.

What does VCU do to accommodate students who drive an hour from home and are then stuck on campus all day? In short, not a lot.

There is a nap pod in the University Student Commons and microwaves sprinkled throughout campus as well. These are both really great things and I appreciate them equally, but what about everything else?

What if I need to change or get ready for an event later in the day? What if I just want 20 minutes to sit alone without people constantly around me? What if I need a nap before driving home late at night? I know I phrased all of these as “what ifs,” but they have all been very real scenarios for me. The answers usually lie somewhere between bathrooms, my car or driving home when I am way too tired.

I know VCU cannot just open a shelter for students to take naps, change

or decompress in, but I do feel like they could do more. Even making some existing spaces specifically available to off-campus students could make a huge difference in terms of quality of life. The library study rooms are an option, but it feels awkward to book one just to sit there or take a nap when there are people who actually need them for group projects, tutoring or other academic things.

It would be insanely nice to know that if I end up on campus longer than I intend to, I have a safe and quiet place to go. The Commons and academic buildings eventually close and that is where the existing nap pod is located. Implementing a few more pods, even bringing back the ones they took away or creating a designated quiet space in a building like the library, which remains open later, could be incredibly beneficial for commuters.

Honestly, these changes could benefit

on-campus students as well. We have all heard various roommate horror stories and sometimes people just need a break from inhabiting the same room. Maybe your roommate has friends over, is studying, is on the phone or you simply just do not get along.

Having a quiet, private and safe space on campus would give students somewhere to go without having to leave campus entirely. A student-only space with 24/7 access that is included with tuition would be incredibly helpful, especially when students do not want to go to the library or spend money just to have somewhere to sit.

VCU has made getting to campus relatively commuter-friendly. Now, it needs to consider what happens after commuters get there.

etPuzzles

Los Angeles Times
Crossword Puzzle

Edited by Patti Varol

ACROSS

- 1 Add some oomph to
6 In good ____
11 "The Marvels" director DaCosta
14 Latch (onto)
18 Speckled horses
19 Dodge
20 Zingy flavor
21 "Sorry, I slipped"
22 "You can lead a horse to water, but you can't make it drink," e.g.?
25 "Frozen" reindeer
26 "Come back ____!"
27 See 91-Across
28 Like rum barrels
29 Ms. Marvel, for one
30 Fruity drink suffix
32 "Oral contracts are binding," e.g.?
35 Cause of a soccer ball bending midair
40 Vigor
41 Fish eggs
42 Character who calls Homer "neighborino"
43 Romania neighbor
45 Letters said while showing a badge
47 "Ew, stop talking!"
50 "A new pope shall be chosen at a conclave," e.g.?
55 Fall (over)
56 Et ____: and others
57 Polite contraction
58 Castle protectors
59 Turn to rubble, briefly
60 Ancient land of the Fertile Crescent
63 Scout leader?
64 NHL trophy namesake
66 "The strike zone is between the chest and knees," e.g.?

- 71 Significant amount of spots?
74 Piglet moms
75 Drank daintily
79 ____back
80 Unsettling look
82 Target of some laser therapy
85 City bond, for short
86 Birthplace of MLK
87 "The ball must hit the cushion before dropping into the pocket," e.g.?
91 With 27-Across, patriotic Muppet
92 Home security co.
93 Malaysian fleet
94 ____ for tat
95 Mexican lager
97 AKB48 genre
100 Miami Beach fair for gallerists and curators
102 "Chickens will be fed in the coop," e.g.?
107 Designer initials
108 Former Yankee slugger, familiarly
109 "That wasn't wholly true"
110 Tennis star Naomi
114 Airport pickup option
118 Space City pro
119 "Wear sensible shoes and a lumbar support belt," e.g.?
122 Coming-of-age story subject, often
123 Cheap, plastic camera type
124 Curtain beam, often
125 Agree to take part
126 Latin 101 verb
127 Copy
128 Public affairs network
129 Source of wealth

DOWN

- 1 Petulant cry
2 Petulant look
3 Salt and pepper, e.g.
4 Like Dracula
5 Air pump meas.
6 Super Monkey Ball developer
7 Rating for mild language, perhaps
8 Countess counterpart
9 French farewell
10 Recliner room
11 Part of a table setting
12 Shoreline feature
13 Sales rep
14 "Gee, that seems unlikely"
15 Treasure-y note?
16 ____ glasses
17 Jen Psaki's network
20 Dress-up box item
23 Liam of "The Naked Gun"
24 Draped neckline
31 Moore of "The Substance"
33 Get close
34 "____ go brag!"
35 Shuts up tight
36 "Hijack" star Elba
37 Dabble in
38 Just hanging about
39 Dozes (off)
42 Sweet Sixteen org.
44 ____ and vigor
45 Toned
46 Sarajevo's region
48 "Light My Candle" singer in 117-Down
49 Long-term goals for some startups
51 Sleeper sofa
52 Dubai leader
53 "Downton Abbey" countess
54 Powdery mineral

- 59 Imagined
61 Issa of "Barbie"
62 "What a downer"
63 Rte. finder
65 Anxiety-related med. condition
67 Novelist Dinesen
68 Tuna roll wrap
69 Singer Stefani
70 Force measured in newtons
71 Start of a lament
72 "Star Trek" android
73 Movie soundtracks
76 Family-friendly hotel room
77 How anchovies may be packed
78 Guinness serving, often
81 59-Across stuff
82 ____ Lanka
83 Michael of "Barbie"
84 Vegan thickener
87 Indonesian island
88 Gawak
89 Tripoli resident
90 Small clock inserts
96 "And I'm finished"
97 "Come along for the ride"
98 Italian "You're welcome"
99 Bet calculations
101 Drinks noisily
102 Wasabi product
103 Some deco pieces
104 ____ Wafers
105 Sludgy stuff
106 Big cat sounds
111 Finger click
112 College basketball coach Barnes
113 Potter's oven
115 Objections
116 Author Wiesel
117 Musical set in Alphabet City
120 Involuntary spasm
121 Southwestern Indian state

READ THE INSTRUCTIONS by Katie Hale

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Sudoku

By The Mephram Group

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

4

Complete the grid so each row, column, and 3-by-3 box (in bold borders) contains every digit, 1 to 9. For strategies on how to solve Sudoku, visit sudoku.org.uk

						1	2		
3	8						6		
				3					
5	1		3						7
4									8
9			4		6			5	
				7					4
		1						8	9
7		4	8						

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